

Contents

1 Strategy	2
1.1 Strategic Management Journal	2
1.1.1 1. Business is personal: How CEO personality influences agency costs	2
1.1.2 2. Stakeholder synergies in acquisitions	2
1.1.3 3. Fast learning and sustained exploration: The role of timely performance feedback	3
1.1.4 4. Local regulatory anticipation and GHG emissions	4
1.1.5 5. Abortion restriction laws and mobility of scientists	4
1.1.6 6. Bias in, symbolic compliance out? GPT's reliance on gender and race in strategic evaluations	5
1.1.7 7. Scaling high and wide: How firms leverage AI and organizational design to overcome the scale-scope trade-off	6
1.1.8 8. Throwing curveballs: A language-based model of curveball questions in quarterly earnings calls uncovers their consequences and antecedents	6
1.1.9 9. Organizing across cognitive asymmetry in human-AI collaboration: A study of perfume creation	7
1.1.10 10. Persuasion in the political marketplace: How firms snitch on rivals to encourage regulatory enforcement	8
1.2 Academy of Management Journal	9
1.2.1 1. Artificial Intelligence and Responsible Research at AMJ	9
1.2.2 2. Innovating More Formally: How Resistance-Led Participation Drives Expansion and Integration in Innovation Control Configuration	9
1.2.3 3. "We're Not Designing with the Same Brain": How Tattoo Artists Navigate Authority-Expertise Asymmetry to Sustain Creator-Client Co-Creation	9
1.3 Academy of Management Review	10
1.3.1 1. How AI Reshapes Multimodal Theorization: An Extension of Kuric and Höllerer's "Theorization as a Prerequisite for Diffusion"	10
1.3.2 2. Copying the Wrong Winner? When Noisy Attribution Reverses Mutual Learning Prescriptions in Denrell, Christensen, Knudsen, and Liu's "The Impact of Learning Mode and Speed on Mutual Learning"	10
1.3.3 3. Boundary Conditions and the Juxtaposition of Externalities: An Extension to Anand et al.'s "Competitive Externalities in Acquisitions"	10
1.4 Administrative Science Quarterly	10
1.4.1 1. Paul Seabright. The Divine Economy: How Religions Compete for Wealth, Power, and People	10
1.4.2 2. Anthony Abraham Jack. Class Dismissed: When Colleges Ignore Inequality & Students Pay the Price	11
1.5 Organization Science	11
1.5.1 1. When Certification Backfires: Negative Spillovers on Noncertified Offerings in Airbnb Plus	11
1.5.2 2. More Versus Better: Artificial Intelligence, Incentives, and the Emerging Crisis in Peer Review	11
1.5.3 3. What Is the Price of Spanning Domain Boundaries? Distant Recombination and the Market Valuations of Firm Inventions	12

1.5.4	4. A Platform Rating System and Vulnerable Workers: Evidence from Field Experiments in Singapore	12
1.5.5	5. CEO Succession Under Anticipatory Awareness Misalignment	13
1.5.6	6. Space and Structure: The Interplay Between Proximity, Unit Boundaries, and Supervision in Shaping Workplace Interactions	14
2	Innovation & Entrepreneurship	14
2.1	Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice	14
2.1.1	1. Measuring Socioemotional Wealth Using Content Analysis: A SEWi-Based Approach	14
2.1.2	2. Acquisitive and Organic Growth in Penrose' s Theory: A Replication and Extension of Lockett, Wiklund, Davidsson, Girma (2011)	14
2.1.3	3. ETP at 50: The Past, Present, and Future of Entrepreneurship Research	15
2.1.4	4. What If We Took Entrepreneurship Practice Seriously? Prescriptive Theorizing From Explanatory Models for Practical Implications	15
2.2	Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal	15
2.2.1	1. Learning to innovate: How and when firms transform intellectual capital into exploratory and exploitative innovation	16
3	General Management	16
3.1	Journal of Management Studies	16
3.1.1	1. Knowledge Will Always Get through: Inventors, International Networks, and Flows of Technological Knowledge between Britain and the United States in the Interwar Deglobalization Period	16
3.1.2	2. Institutional Logics and Relational Inequality in UK Surgery: Demographic Dominance and the Uneven Governance of Careers	17
3.1.3	3. Two Sides of the Same Coin: Sustaining Loan-Use Ambiguity in Microfinance through Harmonizing Practices	18
3.1.4	4. The Interactive Impact of Regulation, Entrepreneurship, and Cultural Values on Technology Adoption: Renewable Energy in the EU	18
3.2	Journal of Management	19
3.2.1	1. Generative AI Models as Wicked Resources: A Dynamic Perspective on Resource Governance	19
3.2.2	2. Identifying and Using Nonlinear and Interactive Control Variables	19
3.2.3	3. Think Before You Speak: Sensemaking and Sensegiving in New CEOs' Strategic Communications with the Capital Market	20
3.2.4	4. Measuring Stakeholder Theory Mindsets: Development and Validation of a Measurement Scale	21
3.2.5	5. A Sensemaking Model of Investor Reactions to CEO Achievement Expression	21
3.2.6	6. How Boards Use Competitor CEO Awards to Interpret Firm Performance in CEO Dismissal Decisions	22
3.2.7	7. Seeking, Shaping, Becoming: A Scoping Review of the Organizational Futures Literature	22
3.2.8	8. Flattening the Baby Bump: An Interdisciplinary Review of Gendered Return-to-Work Decisions After Childbirth	23
4	Papers Without Info / 未获取到信息的论文	23

1. Business is personal: How CEO personality influences agency costs

Authors: Zeyu Zhao, Xiwei Yi, Donald Lange

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70088](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70088)

Published: 2026-04-29

Keywords: agency costs, CEO personality, corporate governance, regression analysis, strategic leadership

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Strategic Leadership
- **Theories:** Agency Theory, Upper Echelons Theory, Big Five Personality Traits

Abstract:

Research Summary: We examine whether CEO personality traits influence the likelihood of engaging in behaviors that impose agency costs on the firm. We use an established open-language machine learning program to measure CEO Big Five personality traits based on CEO remarks during earnings conference calls. We theorize and find that higher levels of agreeableness and conscientiousness in CEOs are associated with lower agency costs (operationalized here as unrelated diversification and the decoupling of CEO pay from firm performance), while higher levels of neuroticism are associated with higher agency costs. By revealing how CEO personality traits affect agency costs, our study offers a new perspective on the sources of agency problems and broadens the application of CEO Big Five personality traits to corporate governance. **Managerial Summary:** This study explores how a CEO's personality can shape decisions that affect company performance. Using an advanced language analysis tool, we assessed CEOs' personality traits based on what they say during earnings calls. We find that CEOs who are more agreeable and conscientious are less likely to make decisions that benefit themselves at the expense of the company—such as expanding into unrelated businesses or earning pay that does not reflect company performance. In contrast, CEOs with higher levels of neuroticism are more likely to engage in these costly behaviors. These findings suggest that understanding a CEO's personality can offer valuable insights into their leadership behavior and help boards and investors make better governance and hiring decisions. **KEYWORDS** agency costs, CEO personality, corporate governance, regression analysis, strategic leadership |

□ Zhao - Business is personal How CEO personality influences agency costs.pdf

2. Stakeholder synergies in acquisitions

Authors: Kate Odziemkowska, Emilie Feldman, Exequiel Hernandez

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70100](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70100)

Published: 2026-04-27

Keywords: corporate strategy, interorganizational relationships, mergers and acquisitions, nonmarket strategy, stakeholder theory

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Strategy, Non-market Strategy, Stakeholder Management
- **Theories:** Stakeholder Theory, Synergy Theory, Reset Effect

Abstract:

Research Summary: Acquisitions can create synergies by combining an acquirer's and a target's pre-existing relationships with nonmarket stakeholders. We introduce the "reset effect" as a novel mechanism that occurs when a firm with cooperative stakeholder relationships combines with a firm that has conflictual relationships, prompting the affected stakeholders to re-evaluate their pre-acquisition strategies. We argue

that post-acquisition conflict with nonmarket stakeholders will decline when the cooperative and conflictual stakeholders brought together by an acquisition are aligned on one or more of the three elements that characterize stakeholder fields: (1) issues stakeholders care about, (2) relationships between stakeholders, and (3) preferences for how issues should be addressed. We find support for these arguments by studying changes in Fortune 500 firms' conflict with environmental movement organizations after acquisitions. Managerial Summary: Acquisitions can create synergies by resetting a firm's relationships with external stakeholders. Studying 25 years of Fortune 500 acquisitions and environmental stakeholder interactions, we find that acquisitions can reduce stakeholder conflict when one firm's cooperative stakeholder relationships Received: 1 April 2026 Revised: 1 April 2026 Accepted: 15 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70100 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–31. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 complement the other firm's conflictual ones. Complementary relationships exist when cooperative and conflictual stakeholders are aligned on issues or have pre-existing relationships with one another. Simply combining conflictual-cooperative stakeholder relationships is not enough, however, and post-acquisition conflict can increase when stakeholder groups are divided over how issues should be addressed. These findings can help managers understand when an acquisition will ease or exacerbate external conflict with stakeholders. KEYWORDS corporate strategy, interorganizational relationships, mergers and acquisitions, nonmarket strategy, stakeholder theory 1 |

□ Odziemkowska - Stakeholder synergies in acquisitions.pdf

3. Fast learning and sustained exploration: The role of timely performance feedback

Authors: Jerker Denrell, Michael Christensen, Thorbjørn Knudsen, Chengwei Liu

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70098](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70098)

Published: 2026-04-27

Keywords: diversity, exploration and exploitation, mutual learning, organizational design, slow learning

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Strategic Management, Organizational Learning, Innovation
- **Theories:** Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Exploration-Exploitation, Target Diversity

Abstract:

Research Summary: How should organizations manage learning dynamics? Strategy theories suggest “more-is-better” —fast, frictionless sharing enhances performance—while organizational learning theory warns that “less-is-more,” as fast learning causes premature convergence. We reconcile this tension by showing that the “less-is-more” prediction depends critically on a key assumption in classic computational models: that information about agents' performance is not continuously updated. When performance information is timely, fast learning enhances exploration. The mechanism is Target Diversity: fast learning allows many individuals to rapidly reach the performance frontier, increasing the set of imitation targets. Organizations thus learn from a diverse, shifting set of targets. The implication is that organizations achieve superior performance not by restricting information or slowing learning, but by making data on choices and performance available more quickly. Received: 9 March 2026 Revised: 9 March 2026 Accepted: 31 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70098 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–32. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: Innovation relies on recombining diverse knowledge, yet facilitating this is challenging. Organizations often encourage copying stars with established track records or reputations, but this can lead to suboptimal results. We demonstrate a superior approach: provide up-to-date performance data and spotlight emergent top performers, regardless of their history. When feedback is timely, rapid learning allows “underdogs” —employees starting from lower positions—to quickly catch up to the frontier via unique knowledge combinations. Spotlighting these emergent successes creates “Target Diversity,” providing the organization with a continually renewed and diverse set of imitation targets. Such a design enhances the exploitation of diverse knowledge and improves long-run performance. KEYWORDS diversity, exploration and exploitation, mutual learning, organizational design, slow learning 1 |

4. Local regulatory anticipation and GHG emissions

Authors: Leandro Nardi

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70097](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70097)

Published: 2026-04-27

Keywords: climate change, environmental performance, geographic proximity, nonmarket strategies, regulation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Corporate Environmental Strategy, Economic Geography
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Regulatory Anticipation, Peer Effects

Abstract:

Research Summary: Regulatory anticipation is a non-market response whereby firms, foreseeing future penalties, adjust their behavior when peers are targeted by regulators. Prior research defines peers using broad jurisdictional boundaries. Instead, I argue that regulatory anticipation may emerge locally, driven by two channels: proximity to peer scrutiny and firms' perceived sanction risks. Examining U.S. facilities' GHG emissions, I exploit variation in local-peer scrutiny arising from a change in the EPA's High-Priority-Violation policy. Difference-in-differences estimates show that heightened scrutiny of county peers is associated with 7% lower emissions among non-targeted firms, driven by those facing higher sanction risks. Distance-decay analyses indicate that these anticipation patterns weaken with geographic separation. The findings encourage managerial attention to local regulatory conditions and suggest that avoiding regulatory deserts could improve policy effectiveness. Managerial Summary: This paper examines how stricter regulatory scrutiny of one firm can prompt nearby, non-targeted firms to reduce their emissions. Using U.S. data on facilities' greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, I find that when a county peer faces heightened oversight, non-targeted firms are associated with about 7% lower GHG emissions on average. These patterns are stronger for firms already at higher risk of environmental penalties, declining as geographic distance from scrutinized peers increases. For managers, the findings highlight the importance of monitoring local regulatory activity and the behavior of nearby peers, as local comparisons can shape stakeholder expectations. For policymakers, the results suggest that avoiding regulatory 'deserts' may enhance the effectiveness of climate-related and environmental regulation. **KEYWORDS** climate change, environmental performance, geographic proximity, nonmarket strategies, regulation 1 |

5. Abortion restriction laws and mobility of scientists

Authors: Beril Yalcinkaya, Waverly W. Ding

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70093](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70093)

Published: 2026-04-24

Keywords: abortion, innovation, mobility, science, social policy

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Strategic Management, Human Capital, Public Policy
- **Theories:** Talent Mobility, Ideological Alignment, Person-Environment Fit, Innovation Ecosystems

Abstract:

Research Summary: We track the enactment of targeted regulation of abortion providers (TRAP) laws in the United States and analyze 4.98 million person-year mobility records for 535,568 biomedical scientists from 1990 to 2018. Our estimations reveal a 0.8–1.6 percentage-point increase in scientists' relocation probability after states enacted abortion-restrictive laws, with substantially stronger effects among junior scientists (1.6–3.9 percentage points). Anti-abortion states also became less likely to be chosen as relocation destinations, particularly by higher-quality scientists. These responses appear driven by ideological misalignment and research-related concerns in fields affected by abortion-related regulation. We further find that states that have adopted TRAP laws experienced declines in scientific research quality, federal research funding, and patenting in relevant technological fields and among local firms. Managerial Summary: Social policies influence the location choices of creative talent, with further implications for organizational and regional innovations. Research scientists are an important part of the regional innovation ecosystem, whose work is intricately related to innovation activities in firms. In a large-scale study of 4.98 million records of half a million biomedical scientists from 1990 to 2018, we reveal Received: 6 December 2024 Revised: 6 April 2026 Accepted: 9 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70093 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–39. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 that restrictive policies, such as restrictions on abortion providers, deter high-quality scientific talent from relocating to certain regions. Our analysis highlights that ideological (mis)alignment and research-opportunity-related concerns, rather than practical concerns like access to abortion services, heighten the effect of abortion-restriction laws on the observed mobility patterns, underscoring the broader implications of policy choices in the sociopolitical environment on where scientific talent chooses to live and work. K E Y W O R D S abortion, innovation, mobility, science, social policy 1 |

□ Yalcinkaya - Abortion restriction laws and mobility of scientists.pdf

6. Bias in, symbolic compliance out? GPT's reliance on gender and race in strategic evaluations

Authors: Tristan L. Botelho, Qingyang (Iris) Wang

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70094](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70094)

Published: 2026-04-24

Keywords: artificial intelligence, bias, evaluations, gender, inequality, large language models, race, strategic evaluations

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Artificial Intelligence in Management, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion
- **Theories:** Symbolic Compliance, Algorithmic Bias, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Research summary: Organizations are increasingly using large language models (LLMs) to support strategic evaluations. We examine whether and how these systems rely on gender and race. We asked GPT to evaluate identical startup pitches varying only the founder's name, shaping gender and race perceptions. Across 26,000 evaluations, GPT did not systematically assign lower scores to underrepresented minorities but avoided ranking them last without increasing winning likelihoods. To explain these patterns, we conducted "Second Opinion" experiments where GPT evaluated pitches alongside inputs simulating human bias. GPT more readily corrected explicit, identity-based bias than bias framed as neutral business critiques, with corrections limited in magnitude. We theorize these findings reflect symbolic compliance: LLMs suppress overt discrimination without substantively altering evaluative logic, allowing inequality to persist in AI-supported strategic evaluations. Managerial summary: Large language models (LLMs), like OpenAI's ChatGPT, are increasingly used in strategic evaluations (e.g., hiring, pitches). We examine whether and how these models exhibit gender and Received: 30 September 2024 Revised: 26 January 2026 Accepted: 5 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70094 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–22. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 racial biases in their evaluations of startup pitches, where we only varied founder names (shaping gender and race perceptions). Across multiple experiments, we find that GPT

evaluators did not systematically assign lower scores to underrepresented minorities, primarily by reducing their likelihood of being ranked last. However, this behavior reflects a symbolic effort to avoid overt discrimination rather than a deeper fairness commitment. While LLMs may not reproduce historical and societal biases in overt form, their ability to correct them remains limited. These results highlight the need for implementing bias mitigation measures before integrating LLMs into high-stakes strategic evaluation processes. **KEYWORDS** artificial intelligence, bias, evaluations, gender, inequality, large language models, race, strategic evaluations 1 |

□ Botelho - Bias in, symbolic compliance out GPT's reliance on gender and race in strategic.pdf

7. Scaling high and wide: How firms leverage AI and organizational design to overcome the scale-scope trade-off

Authors: Feng Wan, Tianxi Yang, Xianwei Shi, Ke Rong, Shahzad Ansari

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70090](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70090)

Published: 2026-04-20

Keywords: artificial intelligence, cross-fertilization, digital firms, organizational design, scale-scope trade-off

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Design, Innovation Management, Corporate Strategy
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Economies of Scale and Scope, Organizational Adaptation, Knowledge Transfer

Abstract:

Research Summary: The trade-off between scale and scope has long posed a strategic dilemma, especially in digital settings, where specialization enables hyper-scaling. Drawing on a longitudinal case study of ByteDance, we theorize how digital firms can overcome this constraint through the use of artificial intelligence (AI) combined with an adaptive organizational design. AI evolves and improves through self-learning and cross-fertilization across domains, becoming increasingly valuable as learning accumulates. This, however, is contingent on access to structurally related data that allow learning to transfer across domains. We show how AI reverses the conventional logic of the resource-based view: rather than valuable resources enabling diversification, diversification amplifies the value of resources. AI thus transforms the scale-scope nexus from being a trade-off into a source of strategic advantage. Feng Wan and Tianxi Yang contributed equally to this study and should be considered co-first authors. Received: 30 September 2024 Revised: 16 March 2026 Accepted: 30 March 2026 DOI: [10.1002/smj.70090](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70090) *Strat Mgmt J.* 2026;1–32. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. 1 **Managerial Summary:** The growing centrality of AI and digital platforms is reshaping how firms pursue and sustain growth. This study examines how ByteDance leveraged AI and adaptive organizational design not only to scale rapidly but also to diversify across industries and markets. Rather than incurring rising costs or coordination complexity, the firm's AI capabilities improved with each deployment through cross-fertilization across domains, enabling more efficient growth across multiple domains. For managers, the findings highlight how dynamic combinations of AI and organizational structure can help overcome traditional trade-offs between scale and scope, opening new pathways for scalable, cross-market expansion in increasingly competitive environments. **KEYWORDS** artificial intelligence, cross-fertilization, digital firms, organizational design, scale-scope trade-off 1 |

□ Wan - Scaling high and wide How firms leverage AI and organizational design to overcome.p

8. Throwing curveballs: A language-based model of curveball questions in quarterly earnings calls uncovers their consequences and antecedents

Authors: Nandil Bhatia, Wei Cai, Sameer B. Srivastava

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70091](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70091)

Published: 2026-04-20

Keywords: analysts, discourse, natural language processing, quarterly earnings calls, social evaluations

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Organizational Communication, Computational Management Science
- **Theories:** Information Asymmetry, Signaling Theory, Language-based Prediction

Abstract:

Abstract

Research Summary

In evaluative contexts, evaluatees typically seek to present themselves in a favorable light, while evaluators ask penetrating questions to assess these claims. Here we develop a framework to identify curveball questions : ones that are on-topic yet perplexing (i.e., difficult to predict) relative to past discourse. We develop a language-based measure of curveball questions and apply it to a corpus of quarterly earnings calls. After validating this question-level measure, we next demonstrate that a call-level curveball measure predicts absolute returns, absolute abnormal returns, and changes in a firm's average analyst rating. Finally, we identify the types of analysts who are most likely to pose curveball questions, the types of firms that are most likely to receive them, and the conditions under which they tend to arise.

Managerial Summary

Even a carefully crafted presentation can be derailed by a challenging question. What makes a question challenging in ways that can be disruptive and how can such a question be measured? We propose that such questions, which we label curveballs, are on-topic, and thus difficult to dismiss or deflect, yet difficult to predict based on prior knowledge. We harness the tools of computational linguistics to develop a measure of curveball questions and apply it to the context of quarterly earnings calls. We show that this measure predicts consequential economic outcomes and highlight the conditions under which curveball questions tend to arise. Our measurement strategy can be readily extended to other evaluative contexts such as job interviews and venture capital pitches.

□ Bhatia - Throwing curveballs A language-based model of curveball questions in quarterly e.pdf

9. Organizing across cognitive asymmetry in human–AI collaboration: A study of perfume creation

Authors: Tomoko Yokoi, Daniella Laureiro-Martinez, Federico Magni, Stefano Brusoni

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70089](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70089)

Published: 2026-04-16

Keywords: cognition, generative artificial intelligence (GenAI), human–AI collaboration, knowledge sharing, organizing

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Strategic Management, Knowledge Management, Human-AI Collaboration
- **Theories:** Cognitive Asymmetry, Tacit and Codified Knowledge, Representational Integration

Abstract:

Research Summary: As organizations increasingly adopt generative AI (GenAI), they face a strategic challenge: not only deciding which tasks AI should perform, but also how to organize the integration of human and AI efforts to produce viable solutions. We propose that a cognitive asymmetry between human's tacit, embodied knowledge and AI's codified knowledge creates a representational gap that complicates human–GenAI collaboration. Through a qualitative study of professional perfume creation, we identify representational integration as an organizing process through which humans and GenAI coordinate to bridge this gap. This process unfolds across three practices: allocating tasks based on cognitive advantages, converting knowledge across tacit and codified forms, and steering GenAI outputs as problem solving evolves. This study advances a novel organizing perspective on human–GenAI collaboration under conditions of cog-

nitive asymmetry. Received: 30 September 2024 Revised: 9 March 2026 Accepted: 30 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70089 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–25. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: Organizations increasingly deploy GenAI in knowledge-intensive work, yet many struggle to convert human and AI contributions into strategic value. This study takes a cognitive lens, showing that humans and GenAI rely on different forms of cognition—and that value emerges when organizations can coordinate and combine them. Successful human–GenAI collaboration therefore requires more than adopting powerful models. It depends on organizing practices that help employees translate across representational formats, relate GenAI outputs to embodied expertise, and iteratively steer GenAI as their interpretations evolve. Investing in these practices and skills allows organizations to harness GenAI’s generativity while recognizing that human sensemaking, tacit knowledge, and contextual understanding remain indispensable for producing coherent, high-quality outcomes. K E Y W O R D S cognition, generative artificial intelligence (GenAI), human–AI collaboration, knowledge sharing, organizing 1 |

□ Yokoi - Organizing across cognitive asymmetry in human–AI collaboration A study of perfu.pdf

10. Persuasion in the political marketplace: How firms snitch on rivals to encourage regulatory enforcement

Authors: Benjamin Barber IV, Gianluigi Giustiziero, Simon Weschle

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70092](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70092)

Published: 2026-04-16

Keywords: Bayesian persuasion, lobbying, corporate political activity, political marketplace, regulatory enforcement

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Corporate Political Activity
- **Theories:** Political Marketplace Theory, Competitive Dynamics, Game Theory, Regulatory Enforcement

Abstract:

Research Summary: We study an important, but largely overlooked, non-market strategy used by firms in the enforcement stage of policy: “snitching,” that is, providing intelligence about potential violations of their rivals in an attempt to persuade regulators to fine them. Building on political marketplace theory, we develop and test a theoretical model of how firms use snitching during regulatory enforcement. We show that in equilibrium, firms snitch when the rival’s violations are likely to cause significant harm to the population. We then derive several boundary conditions outlining when firms will engage in more or less snitching. We find support for our theory in panel data on enforcement actions by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency for more than 8000 facilities over 12 years. Managerial Summary: Firms can use their corporate political activity (CPA) not only to help themselves, but also to snitch on their rivals. Using a formal model, we look at how CPA influences regulatory enforcement. We find firms are most likely to snitch on their rivals Received: 18 December 2023 Revised: 11 March 2026 Accepted: 5 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70092 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–35. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 when their rivals’ potential violations are likely to cause significant harm, since this is when regulators care the most. Our model also outlines when this is most and least likely to occur. We then test our theory using data from the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) and find support for our claims. The EPA is more likely to fine facilities for infractions that process many toxic chemicals, but this effect is much greater when a firm’s rivals are actively lobbying the EPA. K E Y W O R D S Bayesian persuasion, lobbying; corporate political activity; political marketplace; regulatory enforcement 1 |

□ IV - Persuasion in the political marketplace How firms snitch on rivals to encourage.pdf

1. Artificial Intelligence and Responsible Research at AMJ

Authors: Quinetta Roberson

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2026.4002](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2026.4002)

Published: 2026-04-15

Abstract not available. □ Roberson - Artificial Intelligence and Responsible Research at AMJ.pdf

2. Innovating More Formally: How Resistance-Led Participation Drives Expansion and Integration in Innovation Control Configuration

Authors: Shiko M. Ben-Menahem, Vivianna F. He, Georg Von Krogh, Christian Wedl

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2024.0722](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2024.0722)

Published: 2026-04-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Organizational Theory, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Control Theory, Productive Resistance, Enabling Control Configuration

Abstract:

The tension between innovation workers' need for autonomy and managerial demands for formalized control has long posed a theoretical and practical puzzle. Formal controls are often viewed as managerial impositions that constrain innovation, limiting understanding of why and how workers actively participate in expanding them. Drawing on an inductive qualitative study of a multiyear formalization effort at a chemicals manufacturer, we explain how innovation workers' productive resistance—their constructive contestation of emerging controls—drives the expansion and integration of an enabling control configuration. We find that formalization unfolds through bottom-up and topdown activities in which workers' resistance can either constrain or amplify control expansion. Productive resistance, expressed through reformulation, redirection, and reinforcement, addresses deficits in the specificity, scope, and potency of emerging control mechanisms. By surfacing and resolving these deficits, workers and managers advance formalization and cocreate controls that reconcile autonomy with managerial oversight, thereby enabling innovation. Challenging received wisdom in innovation research and control theory, we show that expanding formal controls in innovation does not require minimizing resistance but can proceed through a path of productive resistance. We extend theory on innovation and control by explaining how resistance can generate, rather than hinder, the formal controls that support innovation.

□ Ben-Menahem - Innovating More Formally How Resistance-Led Participation Drives Expansion and I.pdf

3. “We’ re Not Designing with the Same Brain” : How Tattoo Artists Navigate Authority-Expertise Asymmetry to Sustain Creator-Client Co-Creation

Authors: Alexandra Rheinhardt Beer, Amnah Ameen, Dhvani Badwaik, Monique Domingo, Nora Madjar

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2024.1212](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2024.1212)

Published: 2026-04-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Creative Industries, Service Management
- **Theories:** Co-creation Theory, Coordination Theory, Authority-Expertise Asymmetry

Abstract:

Co-creation between creator–client dyads is becoming increasingly common in creative service work. In

these settings, clients hold authority over creative decisions, while providers possess the necessary expertise to evaluate and execute the work, resulting in authority–expertise asymmetry. Yet, little is known about what unique challenges arise from authority–expertise asymmetry and how creative service providers navigate them to sustain co-creation. We address this question through an inductive study of 51 tattoo artists who collaborate with clients to create permanent, highly personal tattoos. Our analysis reveals that creative service providers experience authority-driven inputs as straining co-creation, specifically through strained visioning, feasibility, and participation. To sustain co-creation in the face of these challenges, the providers engage in facilitating co-creation practices, which we define as the set of deliberate practices through which providers shape how authority-driven client inputs enter and function in the interaction under conditions of authority–expertise asymmetry. This facilitation involves three interrelated practices: facilitating ideation, implementation, and coordination. Together, our findings advance a model of how co-creation can be sustained when authority and expertise are structurally decoupled, with implications for theories of co-creation, coordination, and creativity.

Academy of Management Review

1. How AI Reshapes Multimodal Theorization: An Extension of Kuric and Höllerer’s “Theorization as a Prerequisite for Diffusion”

Authors: Shuang Liu

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2026.0095](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2026.0095)

Published: 2026-04-27

Abstract not available. □ Liu - How AI Reshapes Multimodal Theorization An Extension of Kuric and Höllerer’s “Th.pdf

2. Copying the Wrong Winner? When Noisy Attribution Reverses Mutual Learning Prescriptions in Denrell, Christensen, Knudsen, and Liu’s “The Impact of Learning Mode and Speed on Mutual Learning”

Authors: Piotr Tomasz Makowski, Nicolai J. Foss

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2025.0682](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2025.0682)

Published: 2026-04-22

Abstract not available. □ Makowski - Copying the Wrong Winner When Noisy Attribution Reverses Mutual Learning Prescri.pdf

3. Boundary Conditions and the Juxtaposition of Externalities: An Extension to Anand et al.’s “Competitive Externalities in Acquisitions”

Authors: Hao Ma

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2026.0341](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2026.0341)

Published: 2026-04-22

Abstract not available. □ Ma - Boundary Conditions and the Juxtaposition of Externalities An Extension to Anand.pdf

Administrative Science Quarterly

1. Paul Seabright. The Divine Economy: How Religions Compete for Wealth, Power, and People

Authors: Wesley Sine

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261443502](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261443502)

Published: 2026-04-17

Abstract not available. □ Sine - Paul Seabright. The Divine Economy How Religions Compete

2. Anthony Abraham Jack. Class Dismissed: When Colleges Ignore Inequality & Students Pay the Price

Authors: Heather McCambly

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261445365](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261445365)

Published: 2026-04-20

Abstract not available. □ McCambly - Anthony Abraham Jack. Class Dismissed When Colleges Ignore Inequality & Students.pdf

Organization Science

1. When Certification Backfires: Negative Spillovers on Noncertified Offerings in Airbnb Plus

Authors: Heeyon Kim, Qian Wang, Martina Montauti

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.19383](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19383)

Published: 2026-04-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Marketing Science
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Information Asymmetry, Contrast Mechanism, Legitimacy

Abstract:

Research on certification has largely emphasized its positive effects, showing that certification can enhance trust and legitimacy for certified actors and in some cases, generate positive spillovers that benefit uncertified counterparts. Yet, certification programs are frequently scaled back or discontinued, suggesting that their broader consequences may be more complex than commonly assumed. In particular, certification can produce negative spillovers by sharpening distinctions between certified and noncertified actors; through a contrast mechanism, juxtaposition with certified offerings heightens the salience of uncertainty and leads audiences to evaluate noncertified actors less favorably, even when underlying quality is unchanged. We test this argument using data from the launch of Airbnb Plus, a program in which Airbnb certified a subset of listings based on verified quality standards. Employing a difference-in-differences design comparing Los Angeles (where the program was launched) and San Diego (where it was not), we find a negative treatment effect on the revenues of noncertified listings in Los Angeles. This negative spillover is attenuated when alternative quality signals are available, when noncertified listings are less directly comparable with certified ones, and when listings are more difficult to substitute outside the platform. Our findings suggest how certification systems intended to enhance trust and legitimacy can under certain market conditions inadvertently disadvantage noncertified actors. Funding: We benefited from the Cornell Management and Organizations Ph.D. Student Research Grant for this project.

□ Kim - When Certification Backfires Negative Spillovers on Noncertified Offerings in Ai.pdf

2. More Versus Better: Artificial Intelligence, Incentives, and the Emerging Crisis in Peer Review

Authors: Claudine Gartenberg, Sharique Hasan, Alex Murray, Lamar Pierce

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2026.ed.v37.n3](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2026.ed.v37.n3)

Published: 2026-04-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Organizational Theory, Management Education
- **Theories:** Incentive Structures, Institutional Theory, Technological Change

Abstract:

As the AI Task Force for Organization Science, we provide an early account of artificial intelligence' s (AI) impact on both submissions and reviews at a major academic journal. Submission volume has risen 42% since the late 2022 release of ChatGPT, while writing quality has declined. The rise in AI-generated writing accounts for nearly all of these trends. AI-generated writing in reviews has also increased, and is characterized by lower writing quality and less topical diversity than human-generated writing. We are, to our knowledge, the first journal to report these early impacts of AI in the review process. Conversations with editors across scientific disciplines, however, suggest that what we observe is not limited to our journal or to the social sciences. At this early stage of AI adoption, we cannot make a normative assessment about appropriate or ideal levels of AI usage. We can, however, conclude that the current state of AI tools, amplified by existing publish-or-perish incentives, appears to be pushing the system toward an equilibrium of more rather than better research. Reaching an equilibrium in which AI serves as a critical engine of innovation will require that our institutions and the incentive structures they create adapt. Funding: S. Hasan used research funding from Duke University' s Fuqua School of Business. C. Gartenberg used research funding from University of Pennsylvania' s Wharton School. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2026.ed.v37.n3> .

□ Gartenberg - More Versus Better Artificial Intelligence, Incentives, and the Emerging Crisis.pdf

3. What Is the Price of Spanning Domain Boundaries? Distant Recombination and the Market Valuations of Firm Inventions

Authors: Sai Yayavaram, Yuan Shi

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2023.17475](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.17475)

Published: 2026-04-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Financial Economics
- **Theories:** Knowledge Recombination, Evaluation and Appropriation Theory, Market Valuation Mechanisms, Knowledge-Based View

Abstract:

Do investors value firm inventions that recombine distant knowledge across domain boundaries? Analyzing more than 1.5 million firm patents, we find that, despite its strong association with long-term technological impact beyond the local domain, distant recombination of domain knowledge contributes less to a patent' s market valuation when compared to local recombination, thereby inducing a misalignment between valuation and impact. This valuation disadvantage is especially pronounced when distant recombination occurs in a domain primarily built on local knowledge, draws on knowledge from domains with broad applicability, and spans domains with limited connections. Mechanism tests suggest that the inherent evaluation and appropriation challenges for inventions built on distant recombination plausibly account for these findings. We thus establish domain distinctions in knowledge recombination as a key explanation of why innovations' private returns may diverge from their technological impact despite the commonly assumed alignment between the two. Funding: The authors acknowledge financial support from Cornell University. Supplemental Material: The online appendices are available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.17475> .

□ Yayavaram - What Is the Price of Spanning Domain Boundaries Distant Recombination and the Ma.pdf

4. A Platform Rating System and Vulnerable Workers: Evidence from Field Experiments in Singapore

Authors: Vanessa C. Burbano, Wesley W. Koo, Jiao Luo

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2023.18153](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.18153)

Published: 2026-04-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Digital Platforms, International Business

- **Theories:** Platform Governance, Power Dynamics, Indirect Network Effects

Abstract:

Rating systems are a common governance tool on two-sided platforms. Research suggests that, via indirect network effects, rating systems benefit participants on both the rating side and the rated side. However, participants on the rated side may not always recognize the benefits of the rating system and may respond negatively to its introduction. The rating side may anticipate the rated side's negative reactions and react negatively as well, especially when the rated side holds more power over the rating side. To empirically examine participants' reactions to a proposed platform rating system in the context of a substantial cross-side power differential, we conducted two field experiments in collaboration with a Singapore-based labor platform that connects foreign domestic workers with employers (families). We found that employers, on average, were indifferent to the proposed rating system, even when the benefits to them were highlighted, with the highest-income employers exhibiting negative responses. We also found that workers reacted negatively, with those informed of the proposed rating system completely disengaging from the platform. Post hoc interviews and analyses support our interpretation that power differential underlies workers' negative responses to the rating system. This study contributes to the literature on platform rating systems by demonstrating that, in the presence of a substantial cross-side power imbalance, rating systems may not always be perceived positively, even by participants on the rating side, whom the system aims to empower. It also constitutes one of the first efforts in management research to study domestic workers, a highly vulnerable population of workers. Funding: This work was supported by Chazen Institute of Global Business (Columbia University) and INSEAD. Supplemental Material: The online appendices are available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.18153>.

□ Burbano - A Platform Rating System and Vulnerable Workers Evidence from Field Experiment.

5. CEO Succession Under Anticipatory Awareness Misalignment

Authors: Arnaldo Camuffo, Miguel Espinosa, Alfonso Gambardella, Andrea Pignataro

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2025.20384](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20384)

Published: 2026-04-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Executive Compensation
- **Theories:** Agency Theory, Signaling Theory, Dynamic Game Theory

Abstract:

We develop a dynamic model of chief executive officer (CEO) succession under anticipatory awareness misalignment: the divergence between the board's and the CEO's private beliefs about the firm's strategic potential. The CEO chooses unobservable effort, may send costly noncontractible signals, and faces interim termination based on performance thresholds. We derive closed-form expressions for optimal CEO incentive intensity, effort, and fixed pay and show how they are influenced by belief misalignment, CEO capability, and market frictions. We present propositions that explain how belief alignment affects effort and pay, how misaligned types are separated through signaling, and how misalignment impacts firing thresholds and the matching of boards and CEO. We show that misalignment reduces incentive efficiency, increases fixed pay, and increases the probability of early dismissal. CEOs aligned with the board receive higher variable compensation; misaligned types must compensate with signals or accept weaker incentives. The model generates empirically testable predictions on compensation structure, retention, and succession outcomes. Open Access Statement: This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License. You are free to download this work and share with others, but cannot change in any way or use commercially without permission, and you must attribute this work as "Organization Science. Copyright © 2026 The Author(s). <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20384>, used under a Creative Commons Attribution License: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-nd/4.0/>." Funding: A. Camuffo and A. Gambardella acknowledge support from the H2020 European Research Council [Grant 101021061]. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20384>.

□ Camuffo - CEO Succession Under Anticipatory Awareness Misalignment.pdf

6. Space and Structure: The Interplay Between Proximity, Unit Boundaries, and Supervision in Shaping Workplace Interactions

Authors: Jessica A. Reif, Jose Ramon Lecuona Torras, Jonathon N. Cummings

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.19786](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19786)

Published: 2026-04-30

Abstract not available.

Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Measuring Socioemotional Wealth Using Content Analysis: A SEWi-Based Approach

Authors: Shane W. Reid, Chelsea Sherlock, Erik T. Markin, R. Gabrielle Swab

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261444758](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261444758)

Published: 2026-04-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Family Business, Methodological Research
- **Theories:** Socioemotional Wealth (SEW) Theory, SEWi Framework

Abstract:

Socioemotional wealth (SEW) is a foundational construct in family business research; however, its empirical measurement remains limited by reliance on proxy variables and survey data. This study addresses these challenges by developing a computer-aided text analysis method to measure SEW using the SEWi framework. Our approach enables direct, scalable, and multidimensional assessment of SEW through organizational narratives. We detail the development and validation of the measure, demonstrating its reliability and construct validity. This method expands the methodological toolkit for family business scholars and enhances SEW measurement precision, offering a pragmatic solution for broader, comparative, and longitudinal research.

□ Reid - Measuring Socioemotional Wealth Using Content Analysis A SEWi-Based Approach.pdf

2. Acquisitive and Organic Growth in Penrose's Theory: A Replication and Extension of Lockett, Wiklund, Davidsson, Girma (2011)

Authors: Alessandro Lucini-Paioni, Panos Desyllas, Orietta Marsili, Elena Cefis

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261435937](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261435937)

Published: 2026-04-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Firm Growth
- **Theories:** Penrose's Theory of the Firm, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

We replicate Lockett, Wiklund, Davidsson, and Girma's (LWDG) (2011) study, which draws on Penrose's theory to explicate how organic and acquisitive growth interact, using data from 128,368 Dutch firms (2011–2016). Our results confirm LWDG's finding that past organic growth negatively affects subsequent organic growth. However, unlike LWDG, reporting a positive association, we find that past acquisitive growth reduces subsequent organic growth. Extending LWDG's framework reveals that this effect turns positive over time, particularly for complementary acquisitions. While our findings align with Penrose's theory, they also provide a more nuanced understanding of the conditions under which acquisitive growth enhances organic growth.

3. ETP at 50: The Past, Present, and Future of Entrepreneurship Research

Authors: Johan Wiklund

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261441596](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261441596)

Published: 2026-04-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Research Methods, Sociology of Science
- **Theories:** Phenomenon-based Research, Home-grown Theory Development

Abstract:

Entrepreneurship scholars have over-invested in borrowed theories and under-invested in the evidence needed to test them—or to build something better. This editorial, written on the occasion of ETP's 15th anniversary and my departure as Editor-in-Chief, argues for a rebalancing around the research question-design-data trio: important questions rooted in phenomena, designs matched to claims, and serious investment in data quality. The field's greatest strength has always been its willingness to ask important questions, and its most enduring theoretical contributions come from developing home-grown theories addressing these questions rather than importing frameworks from outside. AI makes this rebalancing urgent. When the front end of a paper can be generated by a machine, the distinctive value of scholarship must reside in the question, the design, and the evidence. The field's future depends on producing work that reveals how entrepreneurship actually works, and on exporting those insights rather than merely importing ideas from other disciplines.

□ Wiklund - ETP at 50 The Past, Present, and Future of Entrepreneurship Research.pdf

4. What If We Took Entrepreneurship Practice Seriously? Prescriptive Theorizing From Explanatory Models for Practical Implications

Authors: Dean A. Shepherd, Johan Wiklund

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261435928](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261435928)

Published: 2026-04-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Management Theory, Methodological Research
- **Theories:** Prescriptive Theorizing, Explanatory Modeling

Abstract:

Just because we undertake value-neutral research to explain an entrepreneurial phenomenon does not mean we cannot extend our work through engaging values to prescribe what entrepreneurs (and/or other focal actors) should do. In this editorial, we illustrate how scholars can generate and offer prescriptive theorizing. Specifically, scholars can generate practical implications by (a) focusing on a phenomenon-based problem; (b) identifying focal actors and values; (c) defining desired outcomes; (d) developing an implementation roadmap; (e) thinking about reflexivity and boundaries; and (f) generating testable prescriptions. We offer additional considerations about when and for whom this prescriptive theorizing is most appropriate.

□ Shepherd - What If We Took Entrepreneurship Practice Seriously Prescriptive Theorizing From.pdf

1. Learning to innovate: How and when firms transform intellectual capital into exploratory and exploitative innovation

Authors: Gholamhossein (Amir) Mehralian, Arash Sadeghi, Ralf Wilden

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70028](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70028)

Published: 2026-04-24

Keywords: capacity for learning and transformation, exploitation, exploration, intellectual capital, knowledge base

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Intellectual Capital Theory, Organizational Learning, Organizational Ambidexterity, Capability-based View

Abstract:

Research Summary: Corporate entrepreneurship (CE) requires firms to pursue both exploratory and exploitative innovation, yet limited research explains how intellectual capital (IC) is translated into these distinct outcomes. We develop a contingency model that specifies how and when IC drives exploration and exploitation. We theorize that a firm's capacity for learning and transformation (CLT) functions as a firm-level learning and transformation capability through which IC can be translated into either exploratory or exploitative innovation. Knowledge breadth strengthens the indirect effect of IC on exploratory innovation via CLT, whereas knowledge depth amplifies the indirect effect on exploitative innovation. We test the model in two complementary field studies. Study 1 employs a time-lagged design with objective archival data, and Study 2 replicates the findings using survey data. Results consistently support the proposed theoretical model. Managerial Summary: Firms operating in fast-changing and uncertain environments often struggle to balance developing new products with improving existing ones. Our study shows that simply having strong knowledge resources is not enough. What matters is how effectively firms learn from and use that knowledge. We find that firms perform better when they build strong learning capabilities that help them adapt, recombine, and apply knowledge over time. Importantly, the type of knowledge a firm holds shapes this process: broad knowledge supports new product development, while deep, specialized knowledge strengthens improvements to existing products. For managers, this means focusing not only on acquiring knowledge but also on building systems and practices that continuously translate knowledge into action and innovation. **KEY WORDS** capacity for learning and transformation, exploitation, exploration, intellectual capital, knowledge base

□ Mehralian - Learning to innovate How and when firms transform intellectual capital into expl.pdf

General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Knowledge Will Always Get through: Inventors, International Networks, and Flows of Technological Knowledge between Britain and the United States in the Interwar Deglobalization Period

Authors: Anna Spadavecchia

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70106](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70106)

Published: 2026-04-28

Keywords: deglobalization, interwar period, inventors, knowledge networks, patents, technological knowledge, techno-nationalism

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** International Business, Innovation Management, Economic History, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Knowledge Diffusion, Social Network Theory, Institutional Theory, Tacit vs. Codified Knowledge

Abstract:

Abstract Researchers have highlighted that institutional contexts affect the transnational diffusion of knowledge. However, the influence of institutions on the flow of knowledge through cross-national networks remains under-theorized, limiting our understanding of the dynamics of knowledge creation and the factors that may hinder it. Drawing on data from over 8000 US patents granted to British inventions, alongside a case study of a network of inventors and scientists, this research examines how the interwar phase of deglobalization affected the international diffusion of technological knowledge. The analysis shows that interwar nationalistic states' efforts constrained, rather than fully halted, the cross-border flow of knowledge within networks. Deglobalization particularly hindered the diffusion of tacit knowledge, which depends on personal interaction, whereas codified knowledge in patents and scientific publications continued to circulate more easily. These findings have contemporary relevance and suggest that, despite policymakers' efforts to reverse globalization through protectionist policies, tacit and codified knowledge is likely to continue crossing national borders through the networks of inventors and scientists.

□ Spadavecchia - Knowledge Will Always Get through Inventors, International Networks, and Flows o.pdf

2. Institutional Logics and Relational Inequality in UK Surgery: Demographic Dominance and the Uneven Governance of Careers

Authors: Carol Woodhams, Ira Parnerkar

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70107](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70107)

Published: 2026-04-23

Keywords: demographic dominance, institutional logics, intersectionality, relational inequality, surgical training, UK NHS

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Sociology of Professions, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Institutional Logics Perspective, Relational Inequality Theory, Intersectionality, Demographic Dominance

Abstract:

Abstract Persistent gender and racial inequalities within elite professions remain inadequately explained by accounts focusing exclusively on either intra-organizational processes or field-level institutional dynamics. Relational inequality theory (RIT) provides a powerful account of closure within organizations but offers limited specification of how institutional environments shape variation in inequality outcomes. We bring RIT into dialogue with the institutional logics perspective (ILP), adopting a microfoundational lens to examine how demographic dominance and governance structures jointly shape career inequalities. Using longitudinal data on 3402 junior surgeons across 212 NHS trusts in England, we analyse promotion and exit outcomes across professional subspecialties and employing organizations. Intersectional inequalities are systematically associated with a dominant professional logic as captured by White male density (WMD). Higher WMD amplifies in-group advantages and out-group penalties. However, these effects vary across institutional contexts. Professional subspecialties exhibit stronger and more coherent dominance effects, whereas governance-intensive trusts partially attenuate WMD-associated advantages, particularly in formalized promotion processes, while exit patterns remain less responsive to governance constraints. In doing so, we clarify how the strength of relational inequality regimes varies systematically across institutional contexts and show that demographic dominance and governance centrality jointly shape when and where intersectional inequalities intensify or recede.

□ Woodhams - Institutional Logics and Relational Inequality in UK Surgery Demographic Dominan.pdf

3. Two Sides of the Same Coin: Sustaining Loan-Use Ambiguity in Microfinance through Harmonizing Practices

Authors: Jacob Vermeire, Miguel Meuleman, Jan Lepoutre

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70103](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70103)

Published: 2026-04-17

Keywords: harmonizing practices, microfinance, resourcing, scarcity theory, Ubuntu

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Finance, International Business
- **Theories:** Scarcity Theory, Practice-based View, Ubuntu (Communitarian Ethics), Institutional Ambiguity

Abstract:

Abstract Despite its promise to alleviate poverty through entrepreneurship, microfinance is widely used for household purposes, challenging Western assumptions of microfinance as entrepreneurial finance and raising questions about the viability of microfinance organizations (MFOs). To understand how microfinance persists despite such use, we conducted an embedded case study of a South African MFO operating in a rural, resource-constrained context shaped by Ubuntu—a communitarian ethic emphasizing relational interdependence and mutual care. Drawing on scarcity theory and a practice-based view of financial resourcing, we show how scarcity is collectively navigated through culturally embedded practices that stabilize loan-use ambiguity in everyday microfinance interactions. We find that loan officers and recipients jointly enact three harmonizing practices—reverence for repayment, empathic financial support, and entrepreneurial discretion—that sustain this ambiguity between the MFO’s espoused entrepreneurial schema and enacted livelihood-oriented practices. Through these practices, microfinance remains viable as a community-embedded system of financial support, even as loan use departs from formal entrepreneurial prescriptions. By conceptualizing microfinance as a community-embedded system of financial resourcing rather than a narrowly entrepreneurial intervention, this study contributes to research on microfinance, scarcity, and resourcing in communitarian settings.

□ Vermeire - Two Sides of the Same Coin Sustaining Loan-Use Ambiguity in Microfinance through.pdf

4. The Interactive Impact of Regulation, Entrepreneurship, and Cultural Values on Technology Adoption: Renewable Energy in the EU

Authors: Raquel Antolín-López, Jeffrey G. York, Theodore L. Waldron, Javier Martínez-del-Rio

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70102](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70102)

Published: 2026-04-16

Keywords: climate change, entrepreneurship, institutional theory, policy, renewable energy, technology adoption

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Innovation Ecosystems, Entrepreneurship
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Organizational Legitimacy, Technology Adoption, Policy Design

Abstract:

Abstract How can diverse sources legitimize new technology when it lacks economic parity? Government policies that endorse nascent technologies play a central role through regulatory legitimation. Yet, we know less about whether inducement policies that incentivize adoption or imposition policies that mandate it are more effective, and how that effectiveness depends on other sources of legitimation. We address this question by examining renewable energy adoption by incumbent electric utilities in the European Union from 1998 to 2009, a period when renewable energy had not yet achieved cost parity with fossil-fuel alternatives. We find that inducement policies were generally more effective than imposition policies in fostering adoption. Further, entrepreneurial entry strengthened the impact of inducement policies through pragmatic legitimation, while pro-environment cultural values strengthened the impact of imposition policies through

normative legitimation. By showing how regulatory, pragmatic, and normative legitimation sources interact to shape technology adoption, we offer insights for accelerating technology transitions aimed at combating grand challenges such as climate change.

□ Antolín-López - The Interactive Impact of Regulation, Entrepreneurship, and Cultural Values on T.pdf

Journal of Management

1. Generative AI Models as Wicked Resources: A Dynamic Perspective on Resource Governance

Authors: Alptegin Albayraktaroğlu, Aybike Mergen, Çağla Güven

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261434193](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261434193)

Published: 2026-04-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Resource Governance, Digital Strategy
- **Theories:** Property Rights Theory, Stakeholder Resource-Based Theory, System Dynamics Modeling, Resource Complexity and Uncertainty

Abstract:

The proliferation of generative AI models fundamentally alters organizational capabilities, enabling novel value creation while challenging incumbent governance frameworks. Employing a phenomenon-driven approach, this study integrates and extends property rights theory (PRT) and stakeholder resource-based theory (SRBT) to address governance challenges posed by generative AI. By leveraging system dynamics modeling, we conceptualize the dynamic interplay among stakeholder claims, institutional arrangements, and value appropriation outcomes, highlighting how feedback loops, delays, and accumulations shape these interactions. Our analysis reveals two insights: First, stable equilibrium states in stakeholder claims and property rights arrangements may not invariably lead to equitable outcomes, due to stakeholder power disparities and attribution ambiguity associated with generative AI. Second, framing the evolution of generative AI models as organizational resources from the complementary perspectives of PRT and SRBT reveals distinct resource features largely unexamined in the strategy literature. Hence, we introduce the concept of “wicked resources,” characterizing generative AI models by their inherent attribution ambiguity and emergent unpredictability. Building on prior research on resource complexity and uncertainty in the strategy literature, wicked resources are marked by the difficulty firms face in delineating and enforcing control within shifting sociopolitical contexts. This paper makes three key contributions: addressing the dynamic, multiAcknowledgments: The authors would like to thank the associate editor, the two anonymous reviewers, and the participants of the Paper Development Workshop titled “A World Where You Own Nothing? Demystifying Property Rights Theory” , held at the 2024 Academy of Management Annual Meeting, for their valuable feedback and insightful comments on an earlier version of this manuscript.

□ Albayraktaroğlu - Generative AI Models as Wicked Resources A Dynamic Perspective on Resource Gover.pdf

2. Identifying and Using Nonlinear and Interactive Control Variables

Authors: Andreas Salmen, Diemo Urbig, Herman Aguinis

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261431571](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261431571)

Published: 2026-04-24

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Quantitative Methods, Organizational Research Methods
- **Theories:** Nonlinear and Interactive Effects, Omitted Variable Bias, Statistical Control Theory, Methodological Rigor

Abstract:

Nonlinear and interactive effects (NIEs) are central to management theory. Consequently, although researchers commonly include linear control variables, the omission of nonlinear and interactive control variables (NICs) can lead to incorrect conclusions because the omission can distort statistical tests and effect-size estimates. We reviewed 548 quantitative articles published between 2021 and 2023 in *Academy of Management Journal*, *Journal of Management*, and *Strategic Management Journal*. We discovered that about 73% tested for NIEs, but only 3% included NICs. Also, by reanalyzing a published study, we demonstrate that the exclusion of theoretically relevant NICs can reverse substantive conclusions, highlighting the threat such omissions pose to theory advancement. To address this methodological challenge, we introduce a five-step guide for systematically identifying, evaluating, and integrating NICs into research involving NIEs. The guide offers a structured, theory-driven approach that uses associations among model variables and their linear controls to determine which NICs are critical for unbiased estimation of NIEs. We also explain how to avoid over-control, maintain statistical Acknowledgments: We thank *Journal of Management* Associate Editor Michael Withers and two anonymous reviewers for their constructive feedback and guidance throughout the review process. Previous versions of this manuscript were presented at the Academy of Management meetings in Chicago, August 2024, where it received the Academy of Management Research Methods Division Best Student Paper Award, and at the Strategic Management Society meetings in Istanbul, October 2024. Andreas Salmen gratefully acknowledges a travel grant from the Brandenburg University of Technology Graduate Research School.

□ Salmen - Identifying and Using Nonlinear and Interactive Control Variables.pdf

3. Think Before You Speak: Sensemaking and Sensegiving in New CEOs' Strategic Communications with the Capital Market

Authors: Michelle Lang, Jan C. Hennig, Joseph S. Harrison, Michael Wolff

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261433557](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261433557)

Published: 2026-04-24

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Strategic Communication
- **Theories:** Sensemaking and Sensegiving, Legitimacy Theory, CEO Succession, Impression Management

Abstract:

We extend research on strategic communication by introducing a theoretical model of how newly appointed CEOs engage in sensemaking and sensegiving with the capital market through their first communication of strategic priorities. We conceptualize strategic topic novelty, the distinctiveness of the topics emphasized relative to the predecessors', as an observable dimension of new CEOs' priorities that reflects how they reconcile their desire to establish a unique vision with the need to legitimize their appointment. Our theory suggests that new CEOs draw on situational cues, particularly the nature of the succession (dismissal vs. routine) and the initial market reaction to their appointment, when determining how much novelty to introduce. Specifically, we propose that new CEOs communicate higher strategic topic novelty following dismissals and that this relationship may be strengthened by positive market reactions to their Acknowledgments: The authors would like to thank associate editor Wei Shi and the anonymous reviewers for their contributions toward the development of this paper. We are also grateful to research seminar participants at Texas Christian University (2023), the Academy of Management Annual Meeting (2022), and the Strategic Management Society Annual Conference (2021) for their helpful comments on earlier versions of this manuscript. An earlier version of this paper appeared in the Academy of Management Best Paper Proceedings (2022). Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Michelle Lang, Chair of Management and Control, University of Goettingen, Platz der Goettinger Sieben 3, 37077 Goettingen, Lower-Saxony, Germany.

□ Lang - Think Before You Speak Sensemaking and Sensegiving in New CEOs' Strategic Commun.pdf

4. Measuring Stakeholder Theory Mindsets: Development and Validation of a Measurement Scale

Authors: Jacob Hörisch, Laura Ackermann, Stefan Schaltegger, Bidhan L. Parmar, R. Edward Freeman

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261438089](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261438089)

Published: 2026-04-24

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Business Ethics, Behavioral Stakeholder Theory, Psychometrics
- **Theories:** Stakeholder Theory, Behavioral Stakeholder Theory, Scale Development and Validation, Nomological Network Analysis

Abstract:

For four decades, stakeholder theory has played a key role in many research fields, from strategy to business ethics. More recent developments in the field of behavioral stakeholder theory highlight the importance of individual managers and their mindsets. The role of stakeholder theory mindsets of managers, however, has not been empirically investigated. Despite the prominence of stakeholder theory in management research, no measurement scale exists at the level of individuals that would allow scholars to assess the degree to which a manager agrees with the key assumptions of stakeholder theory. This research develops a scale to measure managers' stakeholder theory mindsets. To do so, we followed scholarly best practices: First, we generated items based on existing stakeholder theory literature and then had expert stakeholder scholars evaluate them. This step was followed by two independent studies for exploratory and confirmatory factor analysis and a nomological network study. The actual scale development was complemented by an additional study, which tests the predictive power of the stakeholder theory mindset scale and demonstrates its incremental validity. As a result, we propose a validated measurement scale of stakeholder theory mindsets, consisting of 18 items that load on Acknowledgements: We are grateful to the anonymous reviewers and the handling editor, Prof. Cuili Qian, for their insightful comments and valuable support during the revision of this manuscript. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Jacob Hörisch, Leuphana University Lüneburg, Centre for Sustainability Management, Universitätsallee 1, Lüneburg, 21335, Germany.

□ Hörisch - Measuring Stakeholder Theory Mindsets Development and Validation of a Measuremen.pdf

5. A Sensemaking Model of Investor Reactions to CEO Achievement Expression

Authors: Andrew Li, Sana Chiu, Dejun Tony Kong, Russell Cropanzano, Chien-Wei Ho

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261436831](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261436831)

Published: 2026-04-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Communication, Investor Relations, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Sensemaking Theory, Terror Management Theory, Agentic Leader Stereotypes, Mortality Salience

Abstract:

Prior research on investor reactions to CEO communication tends to focus on one linguistic cue at a time. Even when multiple cues are considered, they are often examined in an additive fashion as if they were independent from one another. Integrating sensemaking theory and research with terror management theory, we develop a sensemaking model that posits that investors do not react to routine cues from CEOs, such as achievement expression, in isolation. Instead, their reactions are moderated by nonroutine cues such as CEOs' use of death-related words that trigger mortality salience. Under high mortality salience, CEO achievement expression indirectly enhances investors' perceptions of firm investment attractiveness through agentic leader stereotypes and perceived leader competence. Two experiments with investors (Studies 1 and 2) and Acknowledgment: We wish to thank the action editor, Dr. Deidra Schleicher, and the two anonymous reviewers for their highly constructive and insightful feedback throughout the review process. We also wish

to thank Steve Sauerwald and Wei Shi for their helpful suggestions on early versions of the manuscript. An earlier version of the manuscript was presented at the 2021 Annual Conference of the Strategic Management Society. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Andrew Li, Department of Management, Engler College of Business, West Texas A & M University, Box 60809, Canyon, TX 79015, USA.

□ Li - A Sensemaking Model of Investor Reactions to CEO Achievement Expression.pdf

6. How Boards Use Competitor CEO Awards to Interpret Firm Performance in CEO Dismissal Decisions

Authors: Jingyu Li, Steven Boivie, Yi Yang

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261436351](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261436351)

Published: 2026-04-24

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Executive Turnover
- **Theories:** Board Information Processing Perspective, Social Comparison Theory, Behavioral Theory of the Firm

Abstract:

To what extent do boards integrate external comparative signals when making CEO dismissal decisions? Drawing on the board information processing perspective, we propose that competitor CEO awards shape the weight boards assign to firm financial performance in dismissal evaluations. Specifically, when competitor CEOs receive prestigious recognition, boards are more likely to interpret firm underperformance as evidence of managerial inadequacy, thereby increasing the likelihood of CEO dismissal. In contrast, when firm performance exceeds that of industry peers, competitor awards amplify positive evaluations of the incumbent CEO's managerial competence, reducing dismissal likelihood. We further identify three governance-related boundary conditions, i.e., CEO compensation structure, board busyness, and board-CEO demographic similarity, that condition these effects by shaping directors' evaluative expectations, available attentional resources, and relational biases. Using a longitudinal sample of U.S. publicly traded firms from 2006 to 2020, we find consistent support for our theoretical predictions. Our study contributes to the corporate governance literature by demonstrating the extent to which boards embed firm performance evaluations within a broader comparative informational context. In doing so, we also uncover indirect competitive spillover effects of executive Acknowledgments: The authors gratefully acknowledge the Associate Editor, Prof. Wei Shi, and the two anonymous reviewers for their constructive and insightful feedback, which significantly improved the manuscript. This work was supported by the National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant No. 72202198). Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Yi Yang, The School of Management, Xi'an Jiaotong University, 28 Xianning West Road, Xi'an, 710049, China.

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7. Seeking, Shaping, Becoming: A Scoping Review of the Organizational Futures Literature

Authors: Sanjay Jain, Habib Islam, Matthew Farrell, Anil Nair

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261429051](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261429051)

Published: 2026-04-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organization Theory, Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Entrepreneurship
- **Theories:** Sensemaking, Organizational Becoming, Prospective Theorizing, Performativity

Abstract:

Across management disciplines, there is growing recognition that understanding organizational futures—

that is, how organizations engage with futures—is integral to comprehending contemporary organizing and strategizing processes. In this paper, we conduct an in-depth scoping review aimed at organizing and synthesizing the rapidly expanding and fragmented literature on organizational futures across the strategy, entrepreneurship, innovation, and organization studies disciplines over the past several decades. Our survey identifies several research streams in these areas that we classify into three main categories: future seeking, shaping, and becoming. Furthermore, we identify three subcategories within each main group—anticipating, adapting, and non-adapting under future seeking; enacting, designing, and narrating within future shaping; and perpetuating, making/performing, and wayfinding/improvising inside future becoming—and review the key scholarship associated with each of these. In so doing, we provide a comprehensive and coherent map intended to enable this recently flourishing and perennially vital domain of research to move forward systematically. We also envision our review as a platform that facilitates the development of more prospectively-oriented (i.e., forward-looking) theorizing. Finally, we highlight many frontiers to explore in future work, that include more closely examining the role played by imagination, power and affect in the emergence of organizational futures.

□ Jain - Seeking, Shaping, Becoming A Scoping Review of the Organizational Futures
Litera.pdf

8. Flattening the Baby Bump: An Interdisciplinary Review of Gendered Return-to-Work Decisions After Childbirth

Authors: Anna Katharina Bader, Juliet Kele, Jana Oehmichen

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261429932](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261429932)

Published: 2026-04-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Human Resource Management, Organizational Behavior, Gender Studies
- **Theories:** Human Capital Theory, Gender Role Theory, Identity Theory, Capability Approach

Abstract:

Compared to fathers, mothers take significantly more time off work after childbirth to care for infants and are more likely not to return to paid employment. To better understand these gendered outcomes, research on return-to-work after childbirth has grown exponentially. We conduct an interdisciplinary, systematic review of 303 articles to illuminate and compare the factors influencing mothers' and fathers' return-to-work decisions and their outcomes. This research reveals a complex web of factors that affect return-to-work and provides comprehensive evidence of the gendered dynamics that parents face. Based on this review, we synthesize existing research and explore alternative theoretical explanations for the persistent gender disparities in return-to-work. In this process, we identify and evaluate four key theoretical lenses, outlining the themes they address, their underlying assumptions, and their potential limitations: 1) the economic and human capital lens, 2) the resource and support lens, 3) the gender role and identity lens, and 4) the health and well-being lens. We conclude by highlighting the remaining gaps in understanding and propose a novel capability-based research agenda to guide future policy, organizational strategies, and support for families navigating return-to-work decisions after childbirth. Keywords: return-to-work; systematic review; work re-entry; working father; working mother; working parents

□ Bader - Flattening the Baby Bump An Interdisciplinary Review of Gendered Return-to-Work.

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- **Space and Structure: The Interplay Between Proximity, Unit Boundaries, and Supervision in Shaping Workplace Interactions** — Organization Science — [10.1287/orsc.2024.19786](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19786)